Attachment 5

Participant Information Sheet

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

Janne Tukiainen | janne.tukiainen@utu.fi | Version 2.6 – proposed amendment | 20 October 2026

Invitation and purpose

You are invited to participate in a study of how people make group decisions about public-service provision when conditions change. The target is 300 adults recruited through the UTU Choice Lab decision-making laboratory ~~or Tampere University's Decision-making Laboratory (DMLab)~~. You are eligible if you are at least 18 years old and can attend the scheduled laboratory session.

The study is led by Janne Tukiainen, Professor at the Turku School of Economics, University of Turku. It is designed to improve scientific understanding of group and institutional decision making. After all paid decisions, an optional questionnaire asks about your background and political attitudes, including your 2023 parliamentary vote and left–right placement. Answers are analysed as research variables; no individual answer is used to judge or characterize you personally.

Voluntary participation

When you registered with ~~the host laboratory's participant system~~ UTU Choice Lab's UTU RPP/TOKA participant system, you received its general participation rules and privacy information. Participation in this particular study remains voluntary. Before any experimental decision, the interface gives concise study-specific information and asks you to confirm that you agree to take part. It explains that the detailed research question will be described after the paid task, so that knowing it in advance does not influence your decisions. The task rules, payment, data processing, foreseeable risks, and your right to stop are explained before you decide whether to participate. You may decline before the interactive task or stop during the session without giving a reason and without consequences for your studies, employment, or access to University services. If you wish to stop, notify the ~~laboratory manager~~ researcher or trained research assistant so that the interacting group can be managed safely. Information already collected may continue to be used for scientific research in the public interest as described in the separate research privacy notice. ~~The host laboratory may connect your identity to your participant code only until payment is complete. It then removes the link under its procedure, after which the research team cannot locate your individual coded record.~~ oTree creates your study code, which is not linked to UTU RPP/TOKA. The research team deletes its separate code-and-amount list after payment reconciliation. Coded records remain protected personal data until a documented review confirms anonymisation. You may ask Janne Tukiainen about your rights while your record can still be identified, including from a study code you provide.

What participation involves

You will attend one approximately 60-minute session ~~at the host decision-making laboratory~~ in person at the UTU Choice Lab decision-making laboratory. You will sit at an individual laboratory workstation and make decisions on the computer provided there. Data collection is planned for 1–31 October 2026. After the study-specific participation confirmation and unpaid practice, you will complete ~~twenty~~ fifteen paid rounds in two blocks ~~of ten~~ : ten in Block 1 and five in Block 2. You remain in the same ~~anonymous~~ matching pool of ~~10 or 15~~ 5, 10, or 15 participants~~, but the software reshuffles that pool into two or three groups of five before every round~~ . In ten- and fifteen-person pools, the software reshuffles participants into two or three groups of five before every round. In a five-person pool, you play with the same four people throughout.

The final participating roster contains ~~10, 15, or 20~~ 5, 10, 15, or 20 people and must be divisible into groups of five. ~~Ten-person pools are formed whenever possible; one fifteen-person pool may be~~

~~used when needed~~ Five participants form one pool, ten form one ten-person pool, fifteen form one fifteen-person pool, and twenty form two ten-person pools. If more people arrive on time than can enter a valid roster, the ~~host laboratory~~ researcher or trained research assistant applies the study's arrival and compensation procedure before paid play. Once paid play begins, nobody enters or changes matching pools.

Each round begins with 20 experimental points. The five participants choose between two methods for a public-services fund:

- **Group approval required.** The software selects one participant to propose the same fund allocation for everyone and any personal transfer. The other four see the full proposal; at least three must approve. A two–two split rejects it, after which everyone chooses their own allocation.
- **Decision takes effect directly.** The software selects a participant in the same way and the same proposal is possible, but it takes effect without an approval vote by the other four participants.

The method receiving at least three of the five method ballots is used. The selected person is then drawn uniformly at random from the five citizens, so everyone has the same one-in-five chance in every round. Your ballot is not shown to other participants. Everyone sees group totals and their own payoff after the round.

The two possible Block-2 updates

All participants begin in a fictional public-service crisis. During the first ten rounds, each point remaining in the fund creates 1.50 group points under group approval and 2.50 under direct implementation. After the first block, each matching pool is randomly assigned to one update:

- **Conditions improve:** the fictional budget passes, waiting times fall, planning resumes, and the group-approval rate rises to 2.50.
- **Conditions remain strained:** the crisis description and the 1.50 group-approval rate continue.

The direct-implementation rate remains 2.50 and all decision rules remain the same in both updates.

Payment

You receive a fixed EUR 10 participation payment plus a performance bonus of up to EUR 5. After the task, the computer selects one round from each ~~ten-round~~ block: one of ten in Block 1 and one of five in Block 2. The points earned in those two rounds determine the bonus: more selected-round points produce a larger payment. Every 24 selected-round points equal EUR 1. Your total payment is therefore at most EUR 15. If you stop early, the fixed participation payment and any performance payment are handled ~~under the laboratory's payment procedure~~ by the research team. ~~The host laboratory administers information required for payment and statutory reporting separately from experimental responses and removes any temporary identity-to-code link after payment under its procedure.~~ The research team uses a separate code-and-amount list to make the immediate payment. Any named payment receipt or record for statutory reporting is kept separately from the research data and does not contain an oTree participant code.

Possible benefits, inconvenience, and risks

There is no direct personal benefit beyond payment. The study may contribute to research on group decision making and institutions. Foreseeable risks are minimal. The fictional crisis, waiting for other group members, or decisions involving unequal allocations may cause mild discomfort. There is no deception about the decision rules or payment calculation. You may ask the ~~laboratory manager~~ researcher or trained research assistant for procedural help at any time.

Final questionnaire

After the paid task, eleven process questions ask how you experienced the crisis, recovery, institutional performance, approval rule, equal allocation, and transfers. A separate twelve-item background section asks your age group, gender, education, household financial situation, party voted for in the 2023 parliamentary election, left–right placement, general support for democracy, satisfaction with democracy in Finland, view of a strong leader who need not deal with parliament and elections, whether citizens' views influence political decisions, generalized trust, and willingness to take risks. Every background item is optional. ~~Any later substantive addition or replacement would be submitted for the appropriate ethical amendment before it is used.~~ If we later make a major change to the questionnaire, we will obtain any required ethical approval before using it.

In the first ten-person session, you may also answer six short feedback questions at a separate common web address before the final explanation and payment display. Every question is optional, and your payment is the same whether you answer or skip. Ratings are stored as counts and text answers as separate shuffled lists, without your name, study code, or links to your game answers. Please do not enter names, codes, or other identifying details. The research team cannot identify who gave a particular answer.

Privacy, storage, and reporting

The experimental interface uses a participant code rather than your name. It records decisions, laboratory site, group and pool identifiers, assigned update, response times, expectations, questionnaire answers, and payoffs on University of Turku IT servers in Finland. Questionnaire responses include political opinions and voting history and are protected accordingly. ~~The host laboratory retains identifying recruitment and payment information and gives researchers only coded data.~~ UTU RPP/TOKA keeps your registration and attendance information separately; it does not receive your experimental responses, payment information, or oTree code. Access to coded research data is limited to Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel. The data may also be retained for compatible future scientific research. Publications and presentations will not identify individual participants. Details, legal bases, retention, and your data-protection rights appear in the accompanying privacy notice. UTU RPP/TOKA's privacy notice is available at https://toka.utu.fi/tietosuoja/.

Questions

For questions about the study, contact the Principal Investigator, Janne Tukiainen, Professor at the Turku School of Economics, University of Turku: janne.tukiainen@utu.fi; +358 50 308 3620. For data-protection questions about the research dataset, the University of Turku Data Protection Officer can be reached at dpo@utu.fi or +358 29 450 3009. Questions about ~~the host laboratory's separate recruitment and payment register~~ the separate UTU RPP/TOKA participant register are handled under ~~that laboratory's~~ the TOKA privacy notice.

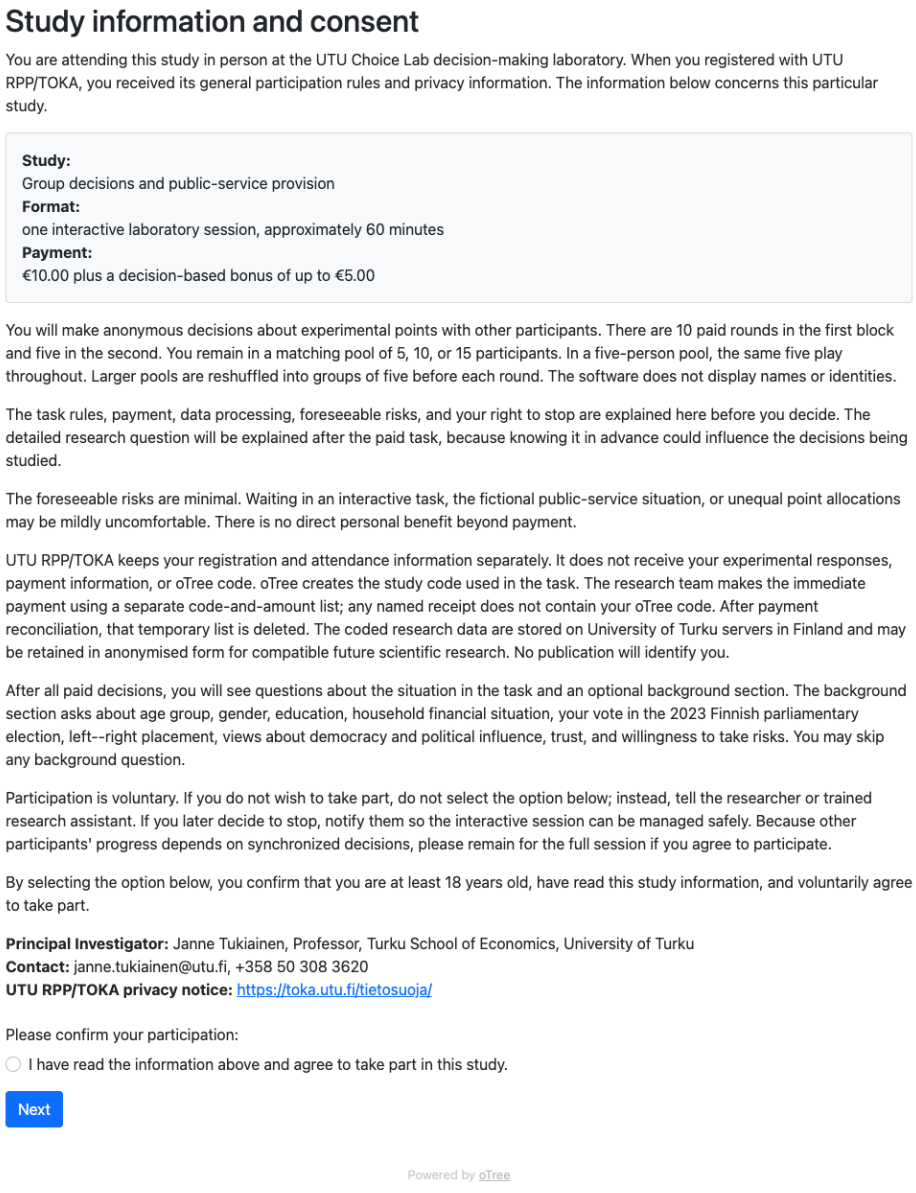
Attachment 5 – screen guide

Examples of the Experimental Interface

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The images below are examples. Values and wording shown on a particular screen depend on the current round and the update assigned to the participant's matching pool. They show the study-specific consent, the interlinked group decisions, and the immediate payment and debriefing information.



Study information and consent

You are attending this study in person at the UTU Choice Lab decision-making laboratory. When you registered with UTU RPP/TOKA, you received its general participation rules and privacy information. The information below concerns this particular study.

Study:
Group decisions and public-service provision
Format:
one interactive laboratory session, approximately 60 minutes
Payment:
€10.00 plus a decision-based bonus of up to €5.00

You will make anonymous decisions about experimental points with other participants. There are 10 paid rounds in the first block and five in the second. You remain in a matching pool of 5, 10, or 15 participants. In a five-person pool, the same five play throughout. Larger pools are reshuffled into groups of five before each round. The software does not display names or identities.

The task rules, payment, data processing, foreseeable risks, and your right to stop are explained here before you decide. The detailed research question will be explained after the paid task, because knowing it in advance could influence the decisions being studied.

The foreseeable risks are minimal. Waiting in an interactive task, the fictional public-service situation, or unequal point allocations may be mildly uncomfortable. There is no direct personal benefit beyond payment.

UTU RPP/TOKA keeps your registration and attendance information separately. It does not receive your experimental responses, payment information, or oTree code. oTree creates the study code used in the task. The research team makes the immediate payment using a separate code-and-amount list; any named receipt does not contain your oTree code. After payment reconciliation, that temporary list is deleted. The coded research data are stored on University of Turku servers in Finland and may be retained in anonymised form for compatible future scientific research. No publication will identify you.

After all paid decisions, you will see questions about the situation in the task and an optional background section. The background section asks about age group, gender, education, household financial situation, your vote in the 2023 Finnish parliamentary election, left--right placement, views about democracy and political influence, trust, and willingness to take risks. You may skip any background question.

Participation is voluntary. If you do not wish to take part, do not select the option below; instead, tell the researcher or trained research assistant. If you later decide to stop, notify them so the interactive session can be managed safely. Because other participants' progress depends on synchronized decisions, please remain for the full session if you agree to participate.

By selecting the option below, you confirm that you are at least 18 years old, have read this study information, and voluntarily agree to take part.

Principal Investigator: Janne Tukiainen, Professor, Turku School of Economics, University of Turku
Contact: janne.tukiainen@utu.fi, +358 50 308 3620
UTU RPP/TOKA privacy notice: https://toka.utu.fi/tietosuoja/

Please confirm your participation:

○ I have read the information above and agree to take part in this study.

Next

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Figure 1: Study information and consent. Before any experimental decision, participants see the session format, payment, foreseeable risks, data flow, optional political questions, contact details, and the notice that the detailed research question will be explained after the paid task.

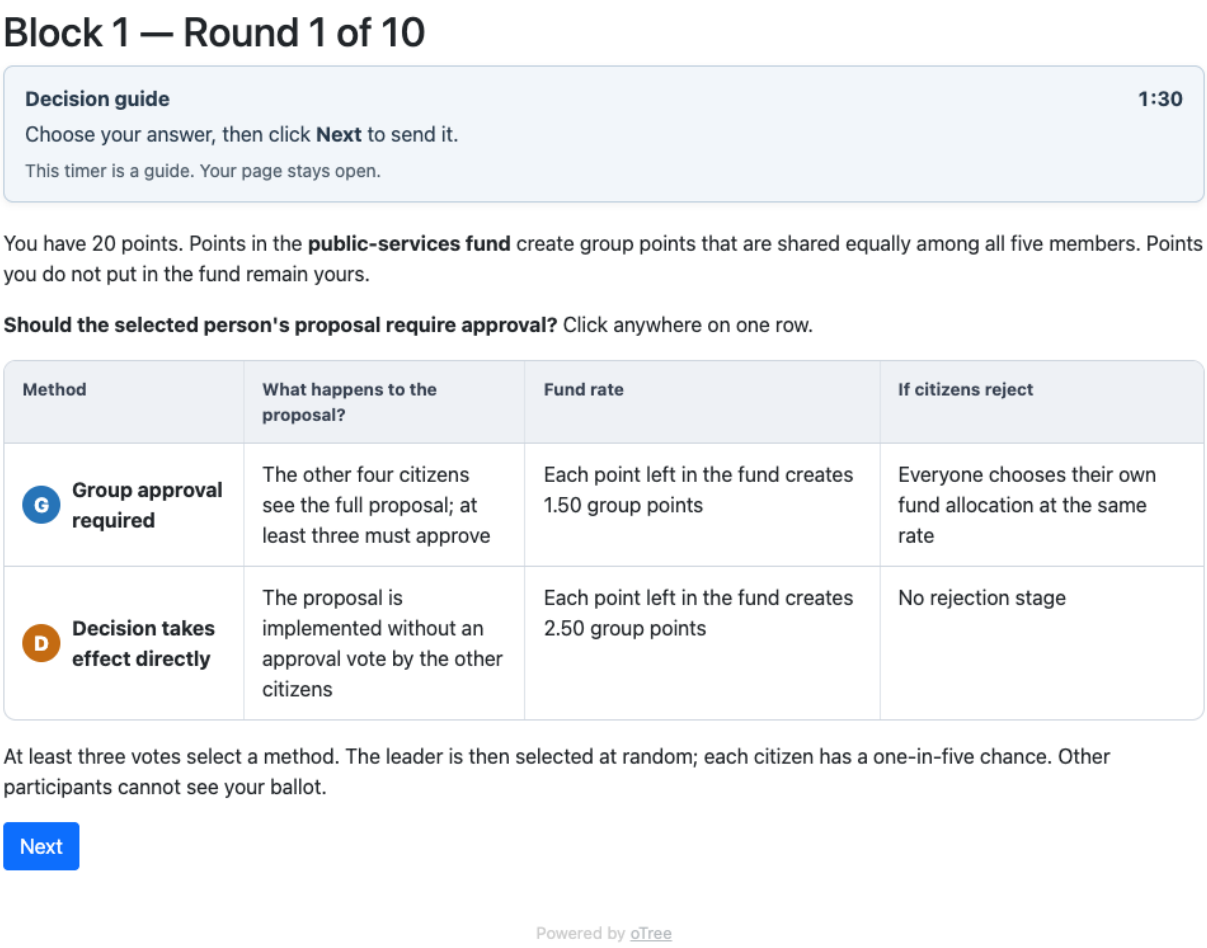


Figure 2: Method ballot. Participants compare the approval rule, fund rate, and consequence of rejection, then select a row. The leader is chosen only after this ballot. The countdown reminds them to choose and confirm, without submitting a decision automatically.

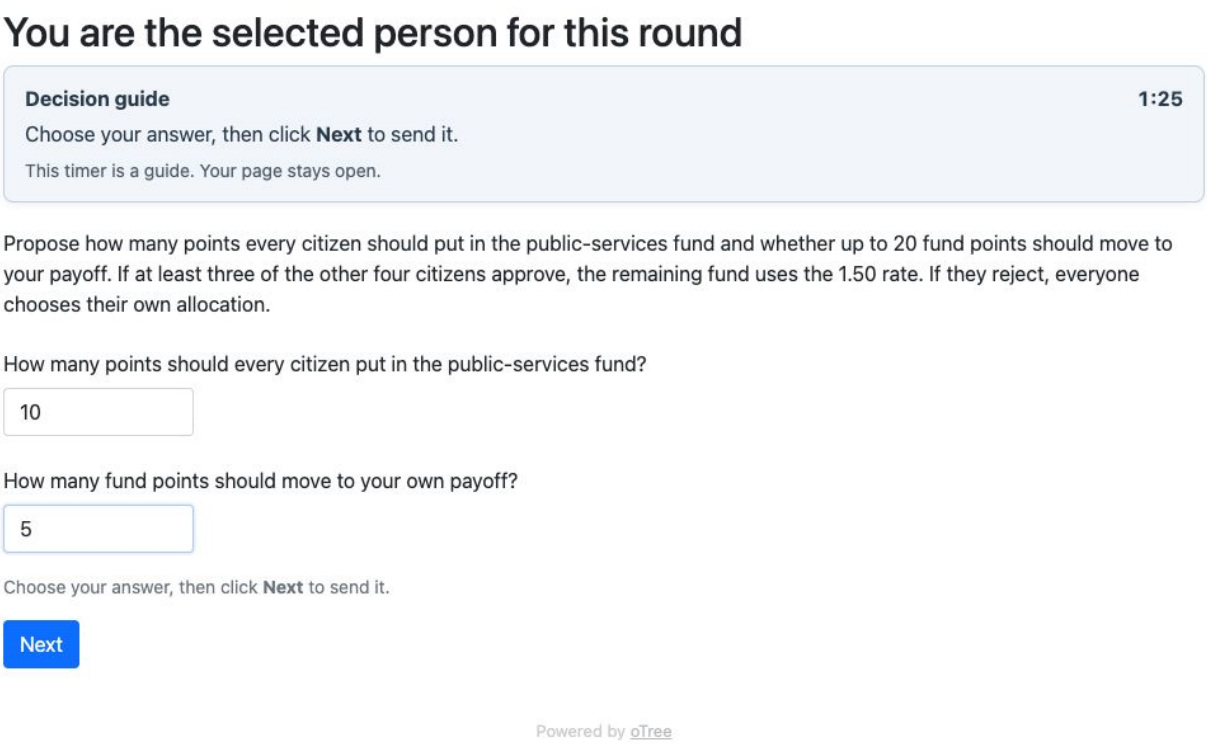


Figure 3: Leader proposal. The selected participant proposes the common fund allocation and any transfer to their own payoff. The screen states whether approval is required and shows the applicable fund rate.

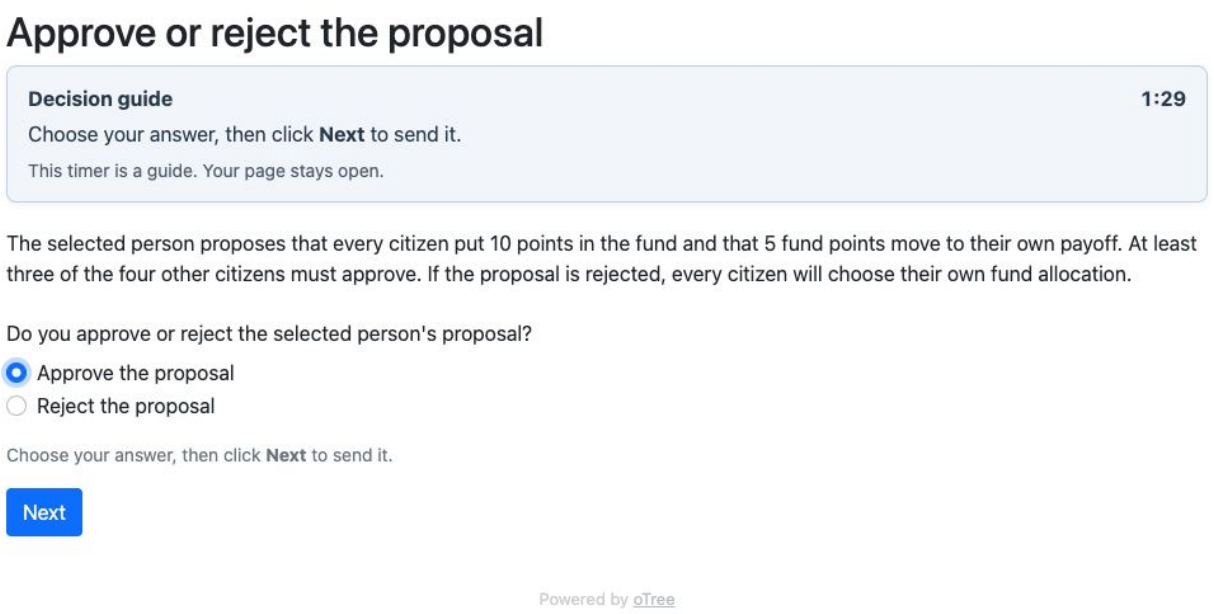


Figure 4: Approval decision. When group approval is required, each of the four nonleaders sees the complete proposal and chooses approve or reject. At least three approvals are required.

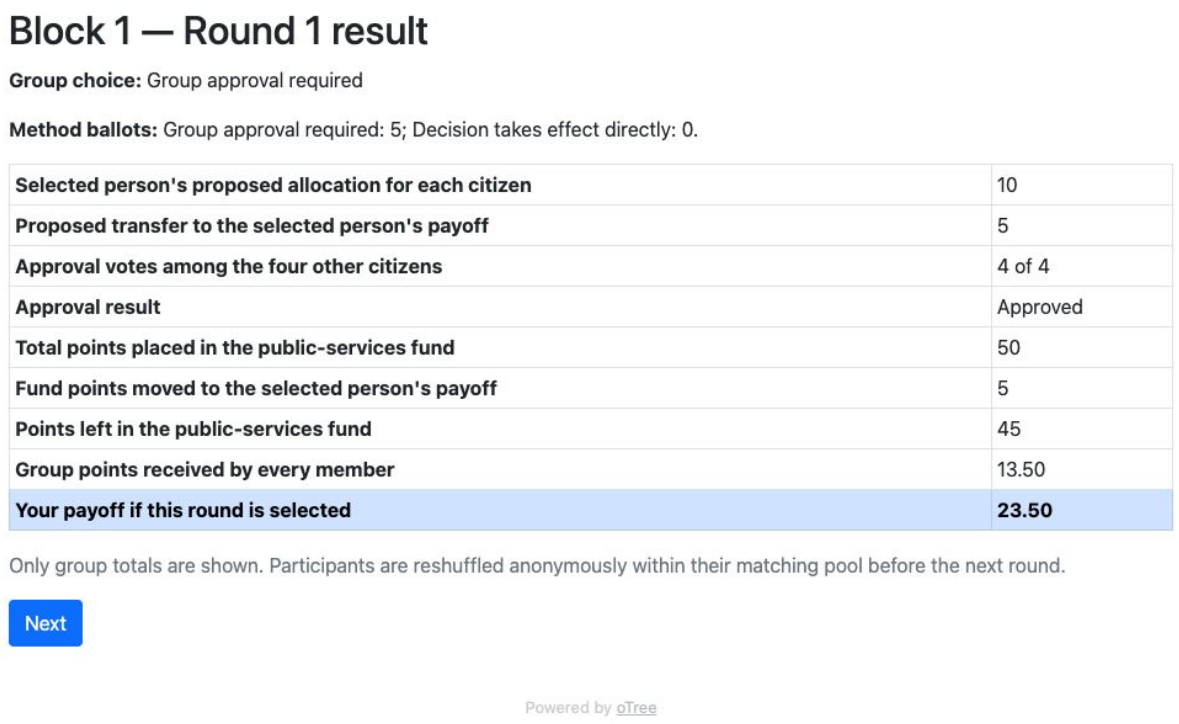


Figure 5: Round feedback. Participants see the chosen method, aggregate ballots, proposal and approval outcome, fund totals, group return, and their own potential payoff. No participant identity is displayed.

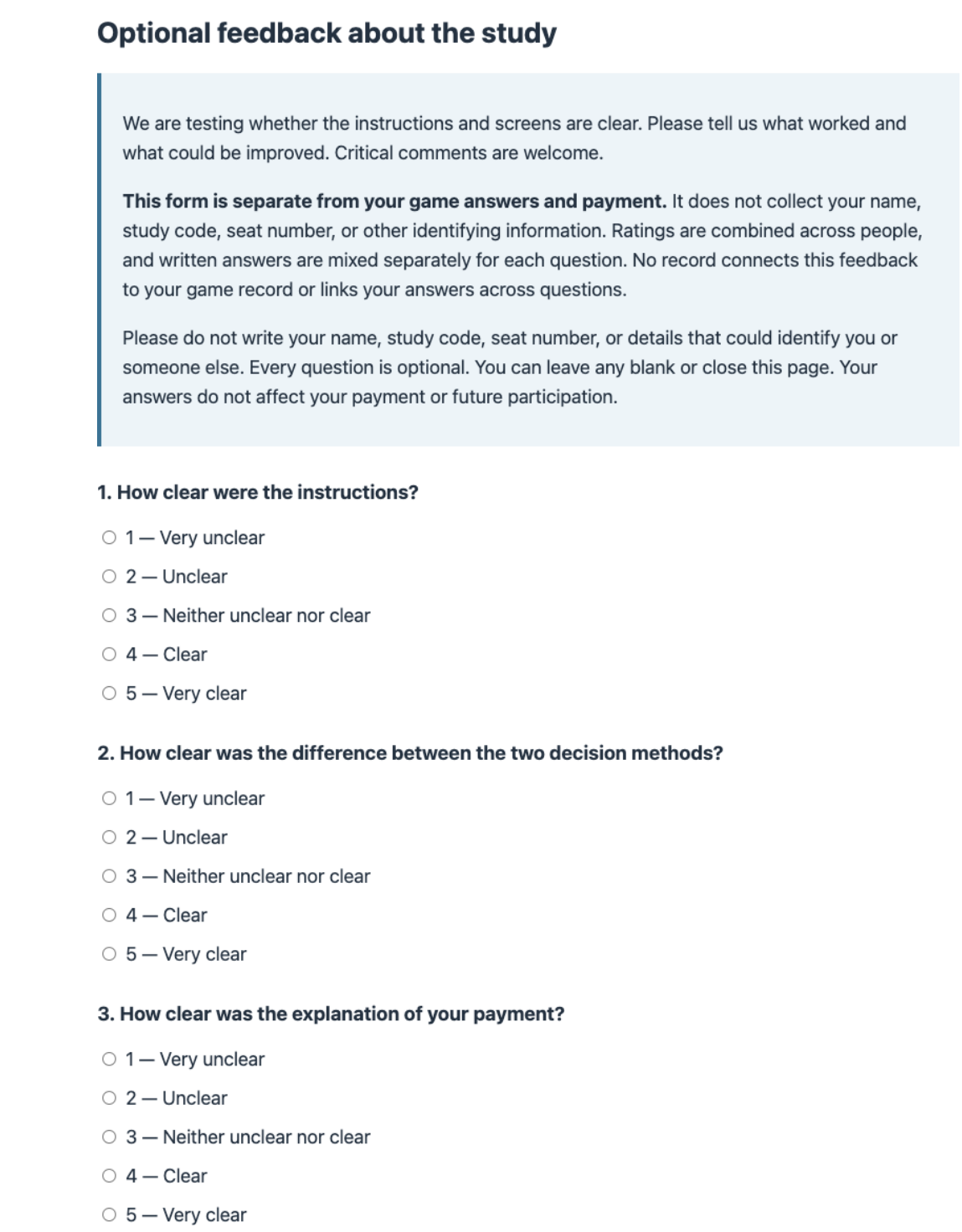


Figure 6: Optional pretest feedback. The separate form explains anonymity and asks about the clarity of the instructions, decision methods, and payment. It is offered only during the first ten-person session, after the main questionnaires and before the debrief.

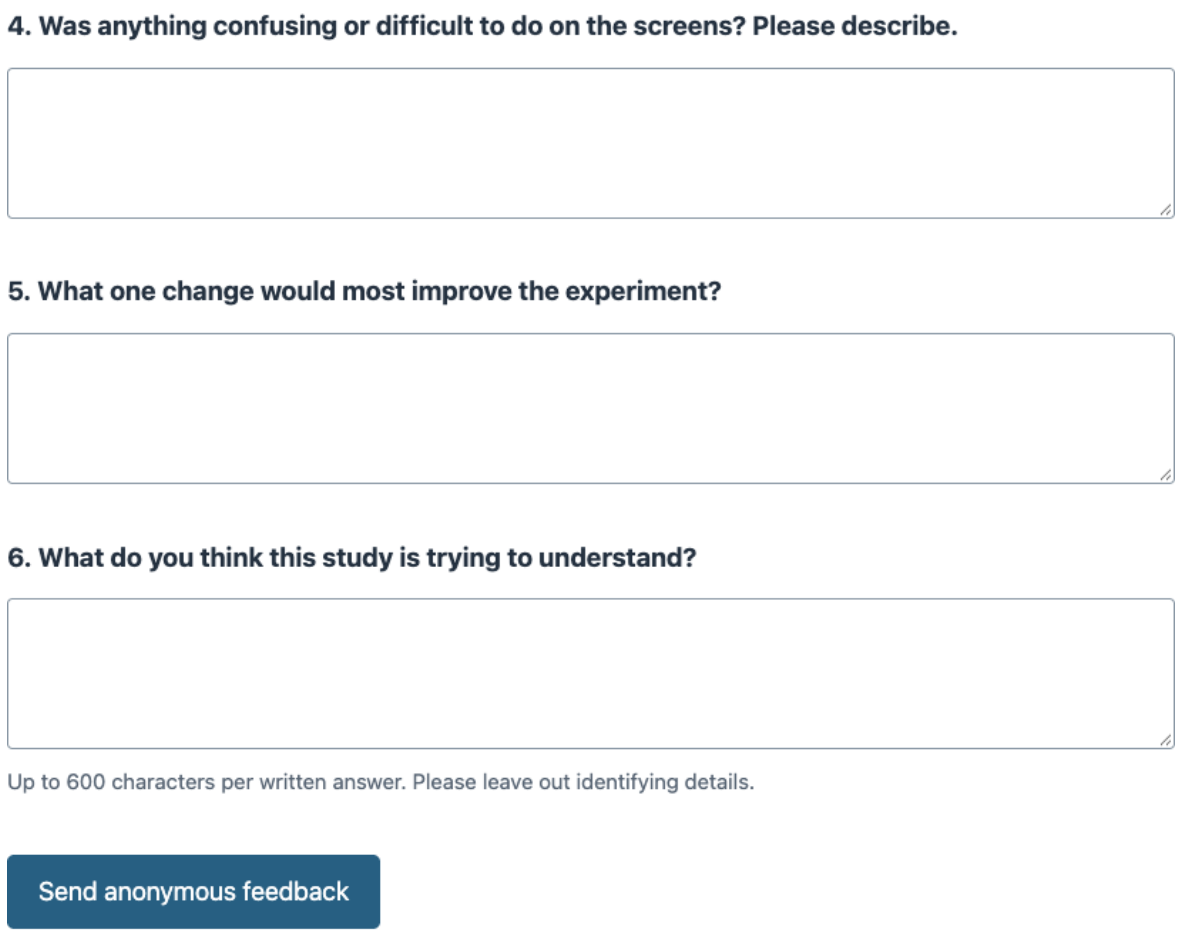
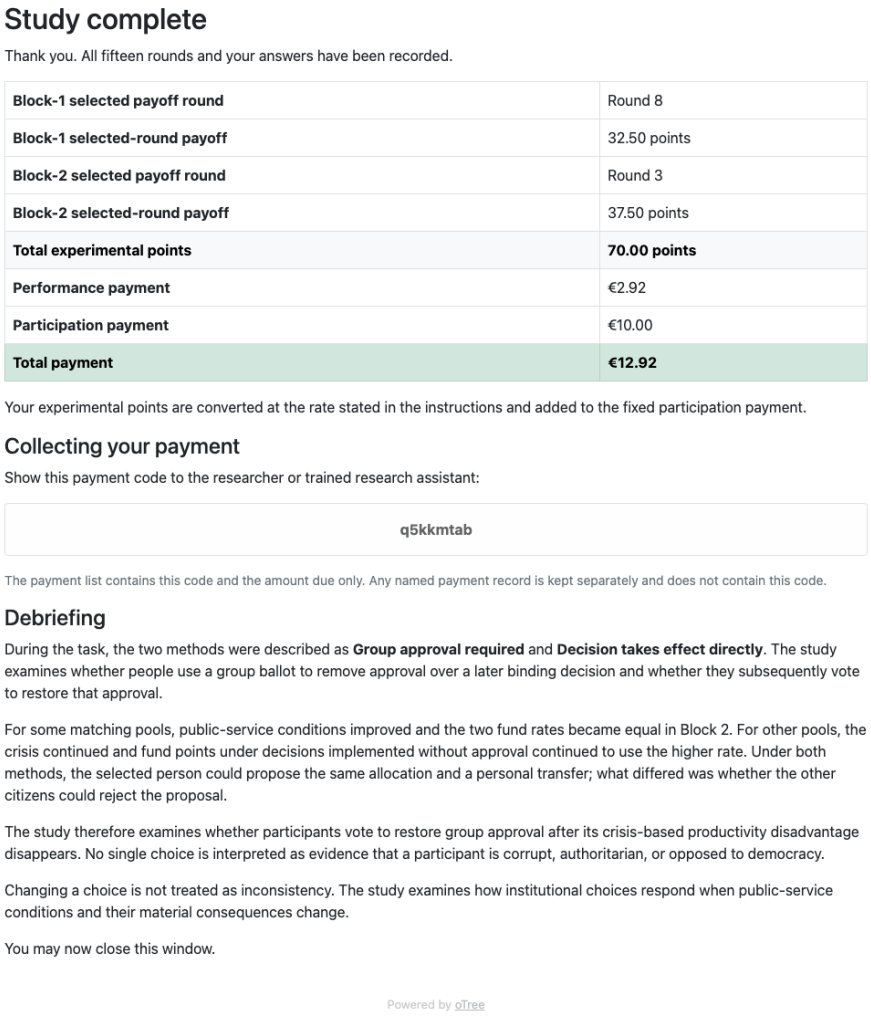


Figure 7: Optional pretest comments. Three short text questions ask about screen difficulties, suggested improvements, and the perceived study purpose. The form requests no identifying details and does not alter payment.



Study complete

Thank you. All fifteen rounds and your answers have been recorded.

Block-1 selected payoff round	Round 8
Block-1 selected-round payoff	32.50 points
Block-2 selected payoff round	Round 3
Block-2 selected-round payoff	37.50 points
Total experimental points	**70.00 points**
Performance payment	€2.92
Participation payment	€10.00
Total payment	**€12.92**

Your experimental points are converted at the rate stated in the instructions and added to the fixed participation payment.

Collecting your payment

Show this payment code to the researcher or trained research assistant:

q5kkmtab

The payment list contains this code and the amount due only. Any named payment record is kept separately and does not contain this code.

Debriefing

During the task, the two methods were described as **Group approval required** and **Decision takes effect directly**. The study examines whether people use a group ballot to remove approval over a later binding decision and whether they subsequently vote to restore that approval.

For some matching pools, public-service conditions improved and the two fund rates became equal in Block 2. For other pools, the crisis continued and fund points under decisions implemented without approval continued to use the higher rate. Under both methods, the selected person could propose the same allocation and a personal transfer; what differed was whether the other citizens could reject the proposal.

The study therefore examines whether participants vote to restore group approval after its crisis-based productivity disadvantage disappears. No single choice is interpreted as evidence that a participant is corrupt, authoritarian, or opposed to democracy.

Changing a choice is not treated as inconsistency. The study examines how institutional choices respond when public-service conditions and their material consequences change.

You may now close this window.

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Figure 8: Payment and debriefing. After all decisions, participants see their selected payoff rounds, total payment, and oTree payment code, followed immediately by the full research purpose. The displayed code and values come from a simulated test session, not a research participant.